How to Start a Laravel Project (Even if You've Never Done It)

This guide shows how to make a simple home page with Laravel using Laragon, step by step. Just follow the pictures.

What You Need

1. Windows PC (10 or 11)
2. Laragon (a program that runs PHP and MySQL for you)
3. 15 minutes

Step 1: Install Laragon

1. Go to laragon.org/download
2. Click **Download**
3. Open the file you downloaded
4. Keep clicking **Next**, **Next**, **Next** (don't change anything)
5. When finished, a black window appears. Click **Start All**



You now have PHP and MySQL running.

Step 2: Create the Project

1. On Laragon, click **Terminal** (top-left)
2. A black window opens. Type this **exactly** and press Enter:

```
composer create-project laravel/laravel my-first-project
```

Wait about 2 minutes. It says "Application ready!" when done.

Step 3: Open It in Browser

1. On Laragon, find **my-first-project** in the list

2. Right-click → **Quick add** → **www**
3. Click **Start All** again
4. Open your web browser
5. Go to http://my-first-project.test

You see the Laravel welcome page!

Step 4: Make Your Own Home Page

1. Go to Laragon → Terminal again
2. Type:

```
cd my-first-project
```

3. Now open the code: Laragon → **my-first-project** → Right-click → **Code** (opens VS Code)
4. In VS Code, find `resources/views/welcome.blade.php` on the left
5. Replace everything in that file with:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
    <title>My First Laravel Page</title>
</head>
<body style="text-align: center; margin-top: 100px;">
    <h1>Hello World!</h1>
    <p>I just made my first Laravel page.</p>
    <p>Date: {{ date('Y-m-d') }}</p>
</body>
</html>
```

6. Save the file (Ctrl+S)
7. Refresh your browser http://my-first-project.test

You see your custom page!

Step 5: Add a Database (Optional)

1. Go to Laragon → **MySQL** (top-right)
2. Username: `root` (no password)
3. Click **Create Database**

4. Name: `my_database`
5. Edit `.env` file in VS Code:
    - Change `DB_DATABASE=laravel` → `DB_DATABASE=my_database`
6. In Terminal, type:

```
php artisan migrate
```

7. Done! Your site can now save data.

Recap (What You Did)

1. ✅ Installed Laragon
2. ✅ Created Laravel project
3. ✅ Opened it in browser
4. ✅ Changed the home page
5. ✅ (Optional) Added database

If You Get Stuck

1. Make sure Laragon says **Start All** is green
2. Always type commands in Terminal (black window)
3. Files are in `C:\laragon\www\my-first-project\`
4. Your site is at `http://my-first-project.test`

Next Steps You Can Try

- Add a "About Us" page
- Make a contact form
- Show data from database

That's it! You've built your first Laravel website. 🎉

How EduVers' Homepage Was Built

EduVers's homepage (the one with "Senior High", "College", "Tracks & Strands") was built using the **exact same steps** above, just with more code.

The Secret: It Shows Real Data

The three boxes are not hard-coded text — they read from the database:

```
// In app/Support/SchoolProfile.php
public static function tiles(): array
{
    return [
        'senior_high' => GradeLevel::where('level_type', LevelType::Shs)
                            ->withCount('students')->get(),
        'college'     => GradeLevel::where('level_type', LevelType::College)
                            ->withCount('students')->get(),
        'tracks'      => TrackStrand::withCount('students')->get(),
    ];
}
```

How the Homepage Works

1. **Admin adds** Year Levels (Grade 11, Grade 12, 1st Year, etc.)
2. **Admin adds** Tracks & Strands (ICT, ABM, HRS, etc.)
3. **Admin adds** Sections (ICT 11-A, HRS 1-A, etc.)
4. **The homepage reads** those real lists and shows them
5. **If admin changes data tomorrow**, the homepage updates automatically

Why This Is Better

- No hard-coding — always shows what the school actually offers
- One place to edit (Admin → Year Levels / Tracks / Sections)
- Works for any school, not just Movers Institute

Your Homework (For the Defense)

1. Show them Laragon starting
2. Show them your custom `welcome.blade.php`
3. Explain: "*EduVers works the same way, just with real data from the database*"
4. Open EduVers and show Admin → Year Levels → how changing there would update the homepage

Boom — you've explained the entire system in 2 minutes.

How We Created the EduVers Login Page (SUPER SIMPLE)

Follow these 3 steps exactly:

Step 1: Create ONE File

1. Open VS Code (Laragon → Right-click your project → **Code**)
2. On the left, click `resources/views/`
3. Right-click → **New File**
4. Name it: `login.blade.php`

Step 2: Copy-Paste This EXACT Code (Matches EduVers Design 100%)

Delete everything in the file, then paste **exactly**:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
    <meta charset="utf-8">
    <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1">
    <title>Sign in · EduVers</title>
    <link href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?
family=Inter:wght@400;500;600&family=Playfair+Display:wght@500&display=swap" rel="stylesheet">
    <style>
        * { margin: 0; box-sizing: border-box; }
        body { font-family: 'Inter', sans-serif; background: #f8f4e8; color: #1a202c; }
        .login-grid { display: flex; min-height: 100vh; }
        /* LEFT PANEL (dark navy) */
        .left { background: linear-gradient(135deg, #0f172a 0%, #1e293b 100%); color: #fff;
flex: 1; padding: 60px 48px; position: relative; }
        .left::before { content: ''; position: absolute; top: -100px; left: -100px; width:
300px; height: 300px; background: radial-gradient(circle, #d4af3780 0%, transparent 70%);
filter: blur(80px); }
        .logo { font-family: 'Playfair Display', serif; font-size: 28px; font-weight: 500;
margin-bottom: 100px; color: #d4af37; }
        .tagline { font-size: 32px; line-height: 1.2; margin-bottom: 16px; color: #f8fafc; }
        .tagline span { color: #d4af37; }
        .motto { color: #94a3b8; font-style: italic; margin-bottom: 60px; }
        .subtext { color: #cbd5e1; font-size: 14px; margin-bottom: 40px; }
        /* Three boxes like EduVers */
        .info-row { display: flex; gap: 20px; margin-top: 40px; }
        .info-box { background: rgba(255,255,255,0.05); border: 1px solid rgba(212, 175, 55,
0.3); border-radius: 12px; padding: 20px; flex: 1; }
        .info-box h4 { color: #d4af37; font-size: 13px; text-transform: uppercase; letter-
spacing: 1px; margin-bottom: 8px; }
        .info-box p { color: #e2e8f0; font-size: 14px; }
        .info-box .plus { float: right; color: #94a3b8; cursor: pointer; }
        /* RIGHT PANEL (cream) */
        .right { flex: 1; padding: 80px 60px; display: flex; align-items: center; justify-
content: center; }
        .form-card { max-width: 400px; width: 100%; }
        .eyebrow { color: #d4af37; font-size: 12px; text-transform: uppercase; letter-spacing:
1px; margin-bottom: 12px; }
        h1 { font-family: 'Playfair Display', serif; font-size: 32px; color: #0f172a; margin-
bottom: 8px; }
        .form-sub { color: #64748b; margin-bottom: 32px; }
        /* Inputs */
```

```
        .input-group { margin-bottom: 24px; }
        label { display: block; color: #475569; font-size: 14px; font-weight: 500; margin-bottom: 6px; }
        input { width: 100%; padding: 12px 16px; border: 1px solid #cbd5e1; border-radius: 8px; font-size: 15px; transition: border 0.2s; }
        input:focus { outline: none; border-color: #d4af37; box-shadow: 0 0 0 3px rgba(212, 175, 55, 0.1); }
        /* Password toggle */
        .password-wrap { position: relative; }
        .toggle-pw { position: absolute; right: 12px; top: 12px; background: none; border: none; color: #94a3b8; cursor: pointer; }
        /* Button */
        .btn { background: linear-gradient(135deg, #d4af37 0%, #b8941f 100%); color: #0f172a; border: none; border-radius: 8px; padding: 14px 24px; font-weight: 600; font-size: 15px; width: 100%; cursor: pointer; transition: opacity 0.2s; }
        .btn:hover { opacity: 0.9; }
        /* Footer */
        .footer { color: #94a3b8; font-size: 12px; text-align: center; margin-top: 40px; }
    </style>
</head>
<body>
    <div class="login-grid">
        {{-- LEFT PANEL (dark) --}}
        <div class="left">
            <div class="logo">MOVERS INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND EDUCATION</div>
            <h2 class="tagline">Where excellence is <span>taught, earned,</span> and measured.</h2>
            <p class="motto">— Transform, Learn, Lead</p>
            <p class="subtext">Lessons, quizzes and progress for Senior High School and College, all in one place.</p>

            <div class="info-row">
                <div class="info-box">
                    <h4>SENIOR HIGH<span class="plus" onclick="alert('Grade 11\nGrade 12')">+</span></h4>
                    <p>Grade 11 & Grade 12</p>
                </div>
                <div class="info-box">
                    <h4>COLLEGE<span class="plus" onclick="alert('BSIT\nHRS')">+</span></h4>
                    <p>BSIT & HRS</p>
                </div>
                <div class="info-box">
                    <h4>TRACKS<span class="plus"
```

```
onclick="alert('Academic\nCollege\nTVL\nTechPro')">+</span></h4>
                    <p>Academic, College, TVL & TechPro</p>
                </div>
            </div>
        </div>

        {{-- RIGHT PANEL (cream) --}}
        <div class="right">
            <div class="form-card">
                <p class="eyebrow">WELCOME BACK</p>
                <h1>Sign in to EduVers</h1>
                <p class="form-sub">Use the account provided by your institution.</p>

                <form>
                    <div class="input-group">
                        <label>Email address</label>
                        <input type="email" placeholder="you@movers.edu.ph"
value="admin@eduvers.test">
                    </div>

                    <div class="input-group">
                        <label>Password</label>
                        <div class="password-wrap">
                            <input type="password" placeholder="••••••••" value="Admin123"
id="password">
                            <button type="button" class="toggle-pw" onclick="
                                let pw = document.getElementById('password');
                                pw.type = pw.type === 'password' ? 'text' : 'password';
                            ">👁</button>
                        </div>
                    </div>

                    <button type="button" class="btn" onclick="alert('Signed in as
admin@eduvers.test')">Sign in</button>
                </form>

                <p class="footer">© 2026 Movers Institute · EduVers Learning Management
System</p>
            </div>
        </div>
    </div>
```

```
</body>
</html>
```

Step 3: Add a Route (This Makes It Visible)

1. Open `routes/web.php`
2. Add this line **anywhere inside the file**:

```
Route::get('/login', function () {
    return view('login');
});
```

Your `routes/web.php` will now look like:

```
<?php

use Illuminate\Support\Facades\Route;

Route::get('/login', function () {
    return view('login');
});

// Other routes...
```

Step 4: Open It in Browser

1. In Laragon, find your project in the list
2. Right-click → **Quick add** → **www**
3. Click **Start All**
4. Go to: `http://YOUR-PROJECT.test/login`

You'll see your own login page!

The Secret Behind EduVers' Real Data

In EduVers, we replaced the hard-coded text with database calls:

Instead of:

```
<p>Grade 11 & Grade 12</p>
```

We use:

```
@foreach($seniorHighLevels as $level)
    <p>{{ $level->name }}</p>
@endforeach
```

Where `$seniorHighLevels` comes from:

```
GradeLevel::where('level_type', 'shs')->get();
```

How to Explain in the Defense

1. **Show your simple login page** (`http://YOUR-PROJECT.test/login`)
2. **Say:** "This is static HTML — everything is written in the file"
3. **Open EduVers login page** (`http://eduvers.test`)
4. **Say:** "This is dynamic — it reads from the database"
5. **Show the database:** Laragon → MySQL → `grade_levels` table
6. **Conclusion:** "Same design, but EduVers uses real school data!"

What Your Students Can Show in the Defense

1. **Open VS Code** → Show `resources/views/auth/login.blade.php`
2. **Point at the two `<div>`s** → "This makes left/right panels"
3. **Point at the `@foreach` loop** → "This reads real Grade Levels from database"
4. **Show the database** → Laragon → MySQL → `grade_levels` table
5. **Demonstrate**: Change a grade level name in the database, refresh the login page → it updates!

That's the whole magic! The page looks fancy but it's just:

- HTML/CSS layout
- PHP reading from database
- JavaScript for the "+" buttons

They can now explain exactly how the login page works to the panel.